

Sesame Turquoise Baker

People & Culture leader, Copenhagen

Clear. Candid. Human.

Copenhagen, Denmark
+45 52 15 91 93
hello@sesamebaker.com
linkedin.com/in/sesamebaker
sesamebaker.dk

I bring clarity to complexity, challenge thinking and make things happen, bringing people with me. 15+ years across the full HR landscape, from operations and business partnering to talent development, executive leadership and global transformation, at Siemens, LEGO, Lantmännen Unibake and Carlsberg, as well as a tech scale-up and a start-up. Strategic in how I think, hands-on in how I work, and direct and collaborative in how I communicate.

EXPERIENCE

Global Head of HR Transformation — 2024 – 2026

YNV Group · investment and operating group, 11 countries

- Building the foundations for HR transformation across 11 countries: working with the CHRO, my team and I led 12 transformation projects.
- Established D365 as the single source of People data and replaced a legacy project structure with a functional hierarchy, reducing organisational units by 70% and giving leaders the data for budgeting and workforce planning.
- Launched a Shared Services hub in Africa in four months, rolling out to six countries and supporting 3,000 leaders and employees (4.8/5 satisfaction). Built two People & Culture knowledge sites, the foundation for an 'Ask HR' AI proof of concept.

Chief People Officer — 2022 – 2024

Uniscale (formerly Patientsky) · healthcare SaaS, around 300 employees

- Executive People leader and adviser to the CEO through commercial scale-up and a company sale (NOK 850m+).
- Part of the M&A team, ensuring accurate and timely People data and documentation throughout the transaction.
- Built job architecture and pay grades, performance calibration and succession for critical roles.

Global Talent Development Director — 2021 – 2022

Lantmännen Unibake · 12 countries

- Working with the CHRO, led global talent reviews and succession planning, executive talent dashboards and competency frameworks.
- Designed and rolled out Leadership Fundamentals for around 500 leaders through a cost-effective train-the-trainer model.

Senior Global Talent Manager — 2019 – 2020

Carlsberg Group

- Managed the Global Leadership Academy (around €1m, with the CHRO and a business development colleague) for leaders at all levels, including the Executive Leadership Team; co-created the Leadership Framework and revised values, and contributed to Carlsberg's first DEI strategy.

Global HR Development Manager — 2017 – 2019

TAJCO Group · Europe, US and China

- Led leadership and capability development across three continents, including a skills matrix for a 1,000-employee plant in China.

HR Business Partner, Senior Global Talent Manager — 2015 – 2017

The LEGO Group

- Partner to the General Manager of LEGO Education; built the case for and co-designed a new global onboarding model. Matured global performance management.

HR Business Partner | Head of HR Service Desk & International Mobility — 2008 – 2015

Siemens Wind Power

- Helped design and implement HR Shared Services, then led AskHR for around 7,000 employees: 3,500 queries a month, 8/10 satisfaction and a "World Class" rating from Siemens HQ for resolving over 90% first time.
- Led International Mobility (around 2,000 delegations a year) and HR business partnering for populations of 250 to 1,500.

IN NUMBERS

15+ years
international HR leadership

4 continents
Europe, Africa, Asia and the US

EXPERTISE

HR Transformation
Operating models, shared services, HRIS and People data (D365), AI in HR, change management

Talent & Leadership
Talent and succession, leadership development, performance, executive coaching

HR Business Partnering
Organisation design, workforce planning, onboarding, M&A People data

CREDENTIALS

- System Thinking, MIT xPRO, 2026
- Professional Scrum Product Owner I, 2026
- Co-Active Professional Coach, CTI, 2024
- Fundamentals of AI in HR, 2024
- Certified Professional Change Management (CPCM), 2023
- Hogan Assessment Certification, 2018
- Situational Leadership (SLX) Train the Trainer, Blanchard, 2017
- DISC and GIA Certified, Thomas International
- Also: IBM Project Management, Josh Bersin Academy, Positive Psychology (UPenn)
- HNC Business Management (Merit), Arden University

LANGUAGES

English (native), Danish (working knowledge). Living in Denmark since 2006.

OUTSIDE WORK

I love the arts, reading, live music, nature and architecture. Favourite place: Louisiana Museum of Modern Art.

Ask my agent at sesamebaker.dk